

Kerry Horton

UX Researcher

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

UX researcher and consumer insights specialist with 4+ years of experience studying how people navigate complex, high-stakes, and emotionally meaningful digital experiences. Skilled in mixed-methods research, usability testing, interviews, diary studies, surveys, A/B testing, and behavioral analysis. Brings a member-centric approach across federal services, AI/search experiences, consumer brands, and large-scale digital products, with a strong interest in helping people build healthier, safer, and more meaningful connections.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Thursday Strategy | Austin, TX

Qualitative Researcher | Apr 2025 – May 2026

- Supported research for Google, Chase, PrizePicks, and Air Canada across AI-powered experiences, search behavior, brand positioning, consumer decision-making, and customer trust.
- Executed focus groups, ethnographies, interviews, rapid research, and diary studies by developing screeners, discussion guides, synthesis frameworks, stakeholder updates, and executive-ready deliverables.
- Translated qualitative insights into recommendations for product, messaging, brand, and customer experience strategy in fast-paced consultancy environments.

Accenture Federal Services | Washington, D.C.

Senior User Experience Researcher | Dec 2023 – Apr 2025

- Conducted usability research across 2024–25 and 2025–26 FAFSA digital experiences with 70+ participants, evaluating form completion, onboarding, help content, post-submission comprehension, and accessibility for 17M+ users.
- Led research with diverse user groups, including first-generation students and individuals with disabilities, applying inclusive research practices to improve clarity, confidence, and access in a high-stakes federal service.
- Triangulated usability findings, A/B testing, behavioral analytics, Google Analytics, and Medallia data into prioritized recommendations that aligned product, content, design, and functional stakeholders.

McKinsey & Company | Atlanta, GA

Senior User Experience Researcher | Jul 2022 – Mar 2023

- Led research for an internal tool redesign, using heuristic evaluations, usability testing with 30+ participants, and 100+ survey responses to identify usability gaps, adoption barriers, and security-related workflow risks.
- Facilitated stakeholder workshops with senior managers to align business, security, and user needs, translating findings into personas, design priorities, and a more intuitive product direction.
- Partnered with cross-functional teams to deliver a Figma prototype and interim workflow solution that simplified navigation, improved usability, and supported safer tool adoption.

Spotify | Seattle, WA

Student UX Researcher & Designer | Sept 2021 – June 2022

- Conducted interviews, contextual inquiries, and usability testing to identify navigation and discovery pain points, informing a more personalized music discovery experience.
- Created personas, journey maps, storyboards, and prototypes to communicate user needs and product opportunities, earning the Award of Excellence for Research at the University of Washington Capstone Showcase.

Uber | Seattle, WA

Student UX Researcher | Oct 2021 – Dec 2021

- Assessed Uber Reserve across mobile and web through surveys, usability testing, and UX metrics including NPS, UMUX-Lite, and SUS, delivering six research-backed recommendations.

EDUCATION

University of Washington | Seattle, WA

B.S., Human Centered Design & Engineering, Human-Computer Interaction | 2022 | Dean's List | GPA: 3.98

SKILLS

Mixed-Methods Research • Usability Testing • A/B Testing • Diary Studies • In-Depth Interviews • Surveys • Ethnographic Research • Focus Groups • Concept Testing • Heuristic Evaluation • Research Planning • Screener Development • Discussion Guide Development • Research Synthesis • Insight Reporting • Journey Mapping • Member Experience • Trust-Informed UX Research • Inclusive Research • Accessibility • Consumer Insights • AI-Powered Experiences • Search Behavior • Behavioral Analytics • Dscout • Dovetail • Qualtrics • UserTesting • Google Analytics • Medallia • Figma • Miro